

HM116: Principles of Economics (Winter 2026)

Instructors: Parul Gupta (Room 1402, FB-4), Cyril Jos (Room 4206, FB-4)

Course Placement: B.Tech (ICT), Semester IV

Course format: 3-0-0 (3 lecture hours)

Course content: This is a core humanities/social sciences course which includes elements of both microeconomics and macroeconomics. It aims to develop an understanding of basic concepts of resource allocation, opportunity costs and market failure. Students would also get an introduction to macroeconomic concepts such as national income accounting, unemployment and inflation. References to monetary, fiscal, and foreign exchange rate policies will help students gain a greater understanding of the role of central banks and governments in the economy.

Textbooks and reference books:

Mankiw, N. G. (2016). *Principles of microeconomics* (8th ed.). Cengage Learning Custom Publishing. (any recent edition may be used)

The CORE Econ Team (2023). *The Economy 2.0: Microeconomics*. Open access e-text available at <https://core-econ.org/the-economy/>

Blanchard, O., & Johnson, D. R. (2012). *Macroeconomics* (6th ed.). Pearson.

Dornbusch, R., Fischer, S., & Startz, R. (2014). *Macroeconomics* (12th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.

Evaluation Plan

Quizzes/assignments: 30 %

End-semester examination: 70%

Course Outcomes

After completion of the course, students should be able to:

- Identify and distinguish between real-world examples of different types of markets, including monopoly, monopolistic competition, oligopoly, and perfect competition.
- Analyse market efficiencies, consumer surplus, producer surplus and social welfare in economic markets.
- Apply macroeconomics principles to estimate the welfare of countries, including the determination of GDP, standard of living and unemployment rates.

P01	P02	P03	P04	P05	P06	P07	P08	P09	P010	P011	P012
	X		X		X						X

Tentative Lecture Distribution

Section	Topic	Number of lectures
Microeconomics	Principles of economics/basic concepts (scarcity, opportunity costs, incentives)	3
	Demand, supply and equilibrium Elasticity of demand/Elasticity of supply	6-7
	Welfare analysis: producer surplus, consumer surplus	3
	Market failure and role of the government, taxes and deadweight loss	6
	Non-technical overview of market structures: perfect competition, monopoly, oligopoly, monopolistic competition	3-4
Macroeconomics	Introducing the economy -GDP, unemployment, inflation	4
	Good Market	3
	Financial Market	3
	IS-LM model	4
	Monetary and Fiscal Policy	4
	International Linkages	4